

(12) **United States Plant Patent**  
**Caster et al.**

(10) **Patent No.:** **US PP24,568 P3**  
(45) **Date of Patent:** **Jun. 24, 2014**

(54) **BLUEBERRY PLANT NAMED**  
**‘DRISBLUEEIGHT’**

(50) Latin Name: *Vaccinium corymbosum* L.  
Varietal Denomination: **DrisBlueEight**

(75) Inventors: **Brian K. Caster**, Salinas, CA (US);  
**Jennifer K. Izzo**, Watsonville, CA (US);  
**Arlen Draper**, Payson, AZ (US)

(73) Assignee: **Driscoll Strawberry Associates, Inc.**,  
Watsonville, CA (US)

(\*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this  
patent is extended or adjusted under 35  
U.S.C. 154(b) by 70 days.

(21) Appl. No.: **13/507,989**

(22) Filed: **Aug. 10, 2012**

(65) **Prior Publication Data**

US 2014/0047590 P1 Feb. 13, 2014

(51) **Int. Cl.**  
*A01H 5/00* (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**  
USPC ..... **Plt./157**

(58) **Field of Classification Search**  
USPC ..... **Plt./157**  
See application file for complete search history.

*Primary Examiner* — Kent L Bell

(74) *Attorney, Agent, or Firm* — Jondle Plant Sciences  
division of Swanson & Bratschun L.L.C.

(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct variety of blueberry plant named ‘Dris-  
BlueEight’ particularly distinguished by having a very low  
chilling requirement, small plant size with medium produc-  
tivity and firm, tart berries with dark blue color, is disclosed.

**2 Drawing Sheets**

**1**

Genus and species: *Vaccinium corymbosum* L.  
Variety denomination: ‘DrisBlueEight’.

**BACKGROUND OF THE NEW PLANT**

The invention relates to a new and distinct blueberry vari-  
ety designated ‘DrisBlueEight’ and botanically known as  
*Vaccinium corymbosum* L. This new blueberry variety was  
discovered in Santa Cruz, Calif. in June 2000 and originated  
from a cross between the proprietary female parent blueberry  
plant ‘MS315’ (unpatented) and the proprietary male parent  
blueberry plant ‘MS122’ (unpatented). The original seedling  
of the new variety was first asexually propagated at a nursery  
in Monterey, Calif. via softwood cuttings. ‘DrisBlueEight’  
was subsequently asexually propagated and underwent fur-  
ther testing at a nursery in Santa Cruz, Calif. for thirteen  
years. The present invention has been found to be stable and  
reproduce true to type through successive asexual propaga-  
tions via softwood cuttings.

Plant Breeder’s Rights for this variety have not been  
applied for. ‘DrisBlueEight’ has not been made publicly  
available or sold more than one year prior to the filing date of  
this application.

**SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION**

The following are the most outstanding and distinguishing  
characteristics of this new cultivar when grown under normal  
horticultural practices in Santa Cruz, Calif.

1. A very low chilling requirement;
2. Small plant size with medium productivity; and
3. Firm, tart berries with dark blue color.

**DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS**

This new blueberry plant is illustrated by the accompany-  
ing photographs which show fruit of the plant as well as the  
flowers and leaves. The colors shown are as true as can be

**2**

reasonably obtained by conventional photographic proce-  
dures. The photographs are of plants that are 12 years old.

FIG. 1 shows a close-up of the mature flowers.

FIG. 2 shows a close-up of the leaves.

FIG. 3 shows a close-up of the whole fruit and a cross-  
section of the fruit.

**DESCRIPTION OF THE NEW CULTIVAR**

The following detailed description sets forth the distinctive  
characteristics of ‘DrisBlueEight’. The data which define  
these characteristics is based on observations taken in Santa  
Cruz, Calif. from 2000-2012. This description is in accor-  
dance with UPOV terminology. Color designations, color  
descriptions, and other phenotypical descriptions may devi-  
ate from the stated values and descriptions depending upon  
variation in environmental, seasonal, climatic and cultural  
conditions. ‘DrisBlueEight’ has not been observed under all  
possible environmental conditions. The botanical description  
of ‘DrisBlueEight’ was taken from 12 year-old plants. Color  
references are primarily to The R.H.S. Colour Chart of The  
Royal Horticultural Society of London (R.H.S.) (2007 edi-  
tion). Descriptive terminology follows the *Plant Identifica-  
tion Terminology, An Illustrated Glossary*, 2<sup>nd</sup> edition by  
James G. Harris and Melinda Woolf Harris, unless where  
otherwise defined.

**DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION**

Classification:

*Family*.—Ericaceae.

*Botanical*.—*Vaccinium corymbosum* L.

*Common name*.—Blueberry.

*Variety name*.—‘DrisBlueEight’.

Parentage:

*Female parent*.—The proprietary blueberry plant  
‘MS315’ (unpatented).



*Male parent*.—The proprietary blueberry plant ‘MS122’ (unpatented).

Plant:

*Size*.—Small.

*Height*.—81.1 cm. 5

*Width*.—93.2 cm.

*Length/width ratio*.—0.9.

*Plant vigor*.—Weak to medium.

*Growth habit*.—Semi-erect to upright.

*Cold hardiness*.—USDA hardiness zone 8B or higher. 10

*Chilling requirement*.—Very low; 150-250 chilling hours.

*Propagation*.—Soft wood cuttings.

*Time of vegetative bud burst*.—Early. 15

*Fruiting type*.—Only on one-year-old shoots.

*Cane renewal*.—Weak.

*Cane internode length (upper half on one-year old shoot)*.—24.44 mm.

*One-year old canes (young canes)*.—Length: 37.85 cm. 20  
Diameter at the base: 7.70 mm. Diameter at the tip: 3.95 mm. Texture: Smooth. Color (One-year old shoot, branch and canes): RHS N144A (Medium yellow-green).

*Five-year old canes (mature canes)*.—Length: 67.18 cm. 25  
Diameter at the base: 13.07 mm. Diameter at the tip: 5.94 mm. Texture: Rough. Color: RHS 146C (Medium yellow-green).

Leaves:

*Length*.—Medium; 6.01 cm. 30

*Width*.—Medium; 3.06 cm.

*Length/width ratio*.—2.0; longer than broad.

*Shape*.—Elliptic.

*Apex*.—Acute to cuspidate.

*Base*.—Obtuse. 35

*Margin*.—Entire.

*Glossiness*.—Medium.

*Pubescence*.—Glabrous (Absent).

*Sheath*.—Absent.

*Arrangement*.—Alternate. 40

*Venation*.—Reticulate.

*Color*.—Upper surface: Dark; RHS 137A (Dark green).  
Lower surface: Light; RHS N138C (Light green).

*Appearance of leaf bud*.—Medium.

*Leaf internode length (one-year old shoot, upper half)*.—Medium; 7.84 mm. 45

Petiole:

*Length*.—3.4 mm.

*Diameter*.—1.46 mm.

*Color*.—RHS 144D (Light yellow-green). 50

Flowers:

*Length (excluding peduncle)*.—Medium; 10.63 mm.

*Diameter*.—6.73 mm.

*Length/width ratio*.—1.6.

*Petal color*.—RHS 157C (Light green-white). 55

*Flower arrangement*.—Thyrse.

*Flower bud*.—Length: 9.0 mm. Width: 3.0 mm. Color on mature buds: RHS 65C (Medium red-purple) and RHS 155B (White).

*Petal number*.—5 fused petals. 60

*Petal shape*.—Orbicular.

*Petal apex*.—Lobed.

*Petal margin*.—Fused.

*Petal length*.—10.63 mm.

*Petal width*.—4.64 mm.

*Fragrance*.—Very faint or absent.

*Time of beginning flowering on one-year shoot*.—Medium.

*Time of flowering (50% full bloom)*.—Early; March 15.

*Pedicel*.—Length: 7.15 mm. Diameter: 0.89 mm. Color: RHS 144C (Medium yellow-green).

*Corolla*.—Aperture diameter: 4.35 mm. Shape: Urceolate. Size of corolla tube: Medium. Corolla tube length: 10.63 mm. Corolla tube diameter: 6.73 mm. Corolla tube color: Medium; RHS 65C (Medium red-purple). Ridges on tube: Present.

*Peduncle length*.—21.31 mm.

Reproductive organs:

*Style length (including stigma)*.—Medium; 9.09 mm.

*Style color*.—RHS 144C (Medium yellow-green).

*Ovary color*.—RHS 136D (Light green).

*Pollen amount*.—High.

*Pollen color*.—RHS 9D (Light yellow).

*Anther color*.—RHS 168C (Medium greyed-orange).

Fruit:

*Size*.—Medium to large.

*Length*.—10.61 mm.

*Width*.—15.38 mm.

*Length/width ratio*.—0.7.

*Fruit pedicel diameter*.—3.69 mm.

*Weight*.—2.2 g.

*Number of berries per cluster*.—5.

*Cluster density*.—Sparse or low.

*Shape in longitudinal sections*.—Oblate.

*Intensity of green color (immature fruit with bloom)*.—Light or clear to medium; RHS 144D (Light yellow-green).

*Color of skin (immature fruit without bloom)*.—RHS N92 (Dark violet-blue).

*Color of skin (mature fruit without bloom)*.—RHS N186A (Dark blue).

*Color of skin (mature fruit with bloom)*.—RHS 107C (Light blue).

*Intensity of bloom (mature fruit)*.—Medium.

*Sepals*.—Attitude of sepals: Incurving. Sepal number: 5 fused. Apex: Rounded lobed. Margin: Fused.

*Calyx*.—Diameter of basin: Medium; 7.44 mm. Depth of basin: Medium; 1.89 mm. Diameter/depth ratio: 3.9.

*Flesh color*.—RHS 193B (Light green).

*Firmness*.—Firm.

*Sweetness*.—High.

*Acidity*.—Low.

*Time of beginning of fruit ripening (one-year old shoots)*.—Medium.

*Harvest season*.—Early to medium.

*Harvest interval*.—June 5-July 19.

Seeds:

*Length*.—1.62 mm.

*Width*.—0.92 mm.

*Length/width ratio*.—1.8.

*Abundance*.—Low.

*Color*.—RHS 165B (Medium greyed-orange).

Resistance to pests and diseases: Data not available.

#### COMPARISON WITH PARENTAL AND COMMERCIAL VARIETIES

‘DrisBlueEight’ differs from parental variety ‘MS315’ (unpatented) in that ‘DrisBlueEight’ has a very low chilling requirement, whereas ‘MS315’ has a medium chilling requirement.



‘DrisBlueEight’ differs from parental variety ‘MS122’ (un-  
patented) in that ‘DrisBlueEight’ has a very low chilling  
requirement, whereas ‘MS 122’ has a medium chilling  
requirement.  
‘DrisBlueEight’ differs from the commercial variety ‘Dris-  
BlueOne’ (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 20,449) in that ‘DrisBlueEight’  
has berries with high sweetness, an early time of vegetative  
bud burst, and leaves with an acute to cuspidate apex and an  
obtuse base, whereas ‘DrisBlueOne’ has berries with medium  
sweetness, a medium time of vegetative bud burst, and leaves  
with a broadly acute apex and broadly acute to rounded base.  
Additionally, ‘DrisBlueEight’ has a very low chilling require-  
ment, whereas ‘DrisBlueOne’ has a medium chilling require-  
ment.

‘DrisBlueEight’ differs from the commercial variety ‘Dris-  
BlueTwo’ (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 20,488), in that ‘Dris-  
BlueEight’ has leaves with an entire margin, oblate shaped  
berries, and a high amount of pollen, whereas ‘DrisBlueTwo’  
has leaves with serrulate margin, nearly spherical shaped  
berries and a sparse amount of pollen. Additionally, ‘Dris-  
BlueEight’ has a very low chilling requirement, whereas  
‘DrisBlueTwo’ has a medium chilling requirement.

We claim:

1. A new and distinct variety of blueberry plant named  
‘DrisBlueEight’ as shown and described herein.

\* \* \* \* \*



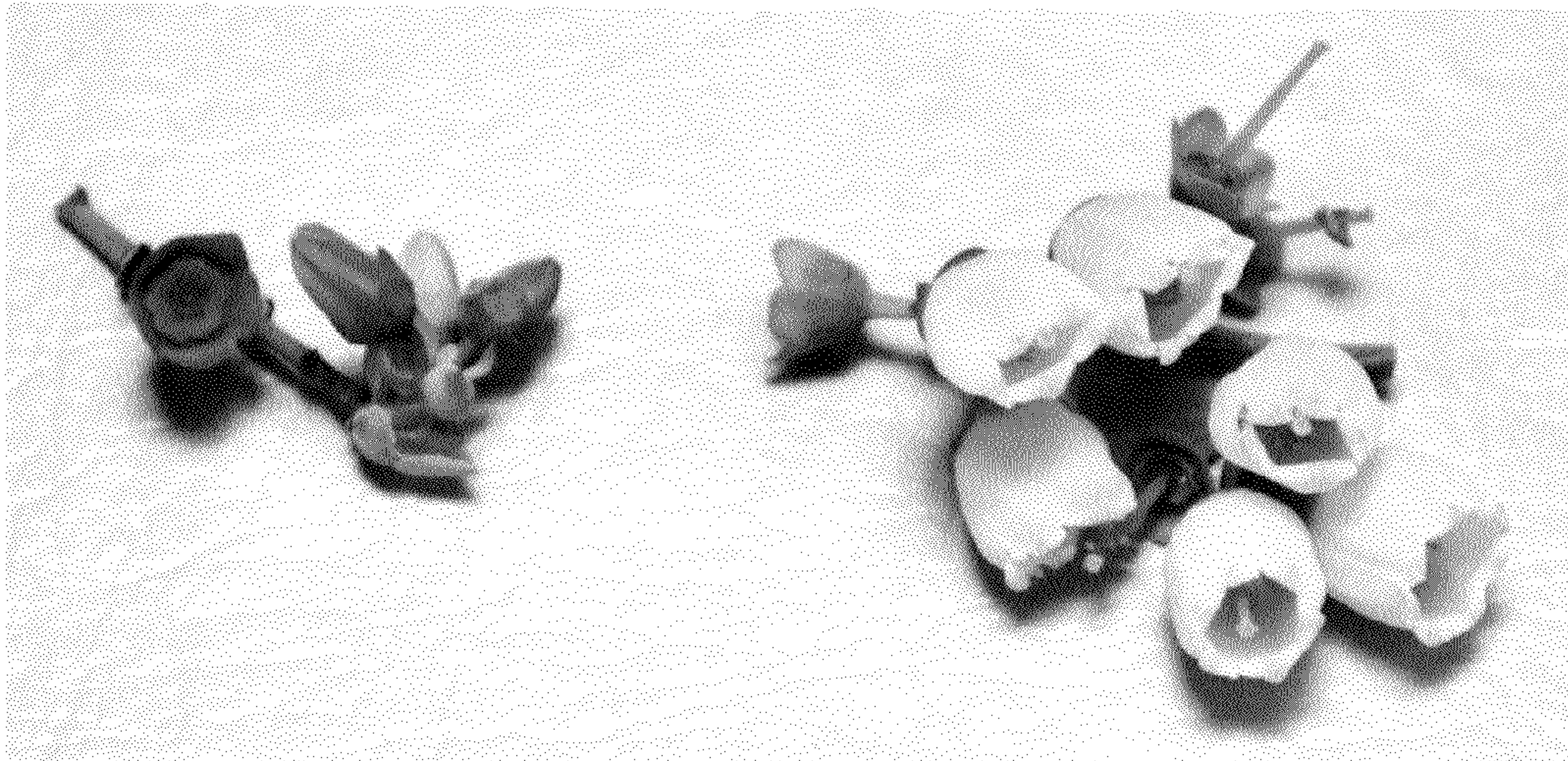


FIG. 1

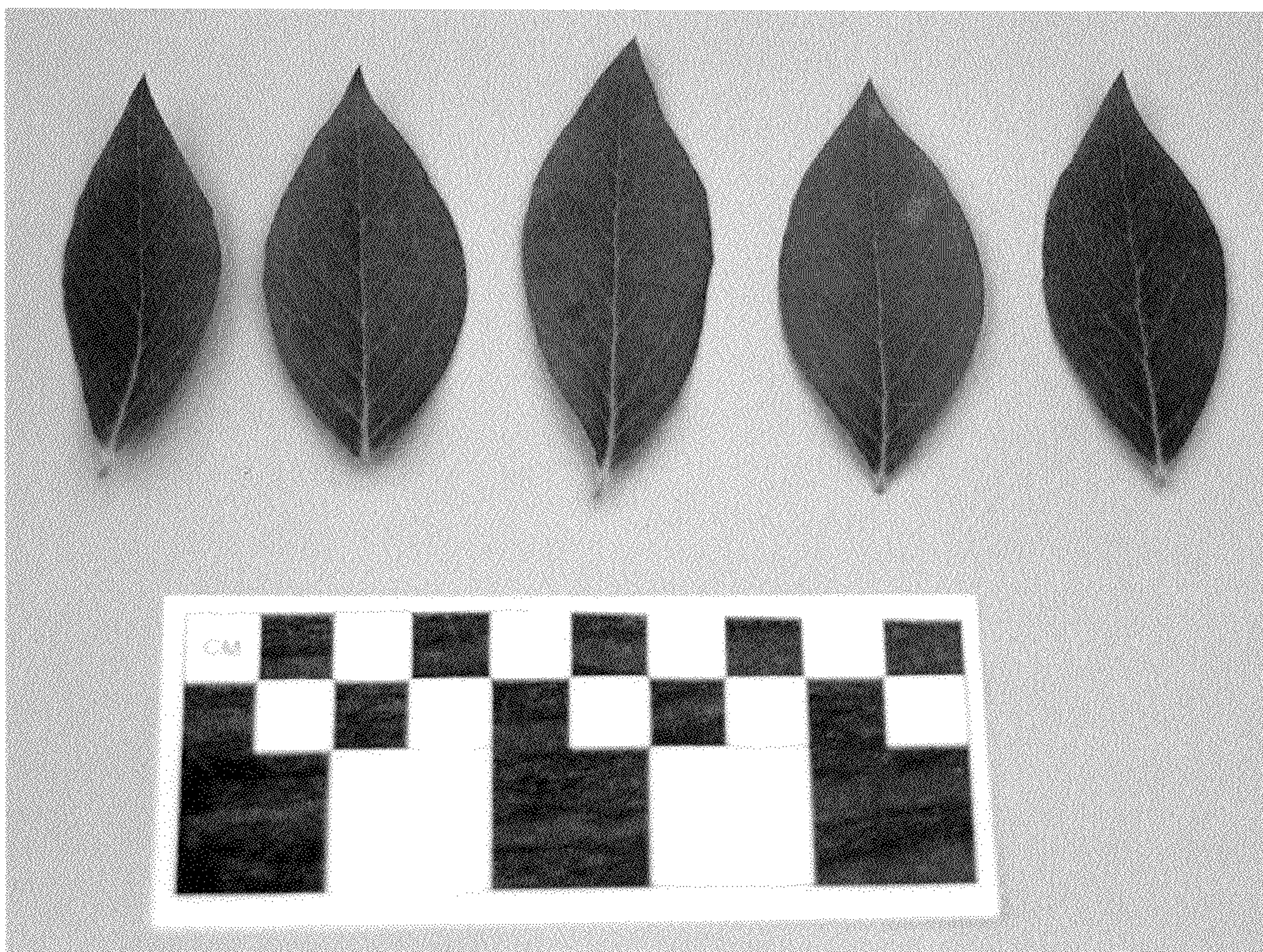


FIG. 2



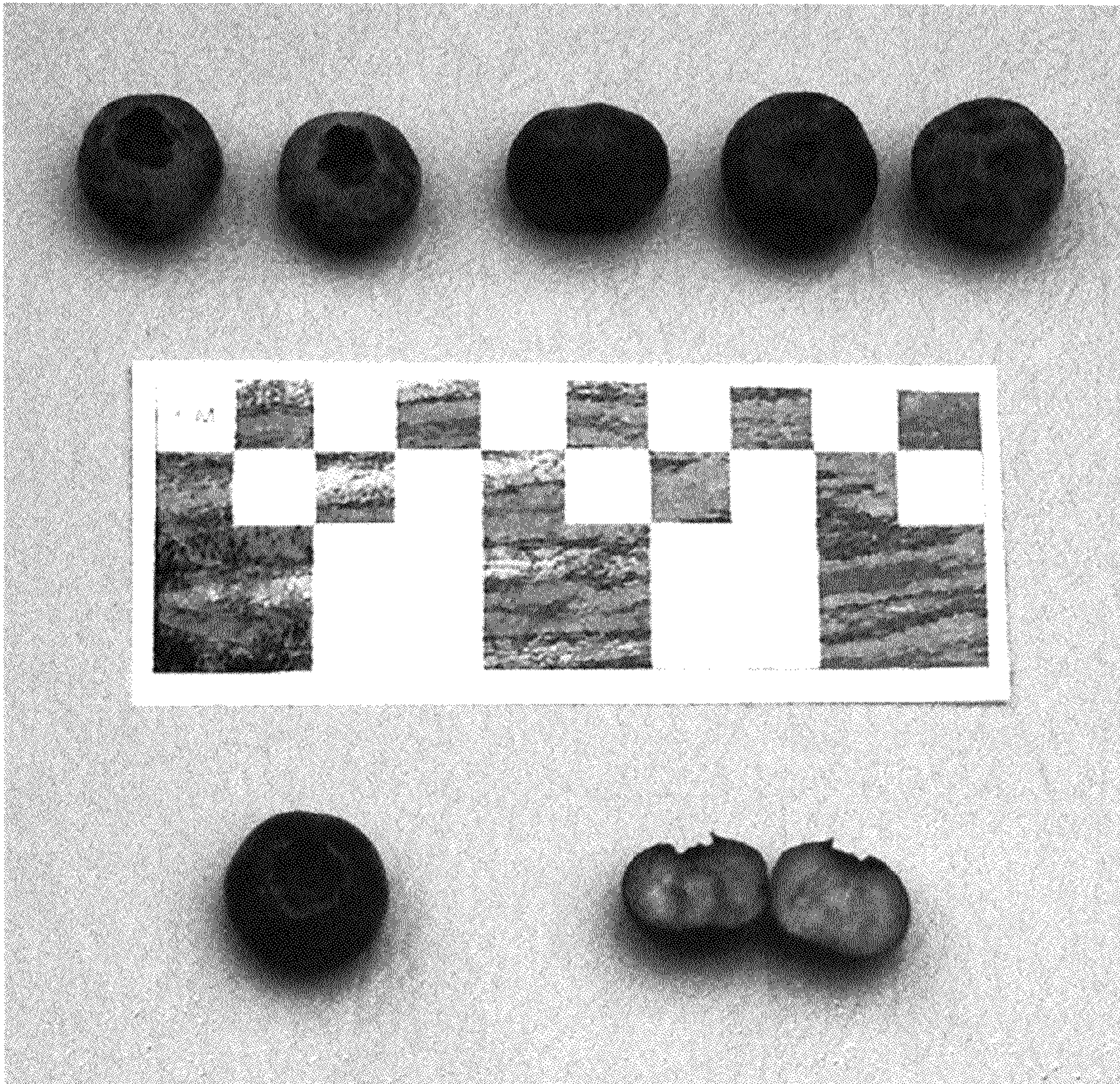


FIG. 3



UNITED STATES PATENT AND TRADEMARK OFFICE  
**CERTIFICATE OF CORRECTION**

PATENT NO. : PP24,568 P3  
APPLICATION NO. : 13/507989  
DATED : June 24, 2014  
INVENTOR(S) : Brian K. Caster et al.

Page 1 of 1

It is certified that error appears in the above-identified patent and that said Letters Patent is hereby corrected as shown below:

In the specification,

In column 1, line 10, delete “female” and insert -- male --, therefor.

In column 1, line 11, delete “male” and insert -- female --, therefor.

In column 2, line 37, delete “Female” and insert -- Male --, therefor.

In column 3, line 1, delete “Male” and insert -- Female --, therefor.

Signed and Sealed this  
Twenty-second Day of November, 2016



Michelle K. Lee  
*Director of the United States Patent and Trademark Office*